

ILIKEITDEEP • A GUIDED JOURNAL



The Parent I Didn't Have

*For grieving the parent you needed,
but never had.*



I LIKE IT DEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL



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For grieving the parent you needed, but never had.

*"Write it. Feel it. Heal it.
Your journal knows the real you."*





BEFORE YOU BEGIN

A Note Before You Begin



This isn't grief for a person who died. It's grief for a person who was never fully there — physically absent, or present but unavailable in the ways that mattered. That kind of loss doesn't get a funeral or a casserole from the neighbors. It doesn't always get believed. But missing something you never had is real grief, and it deserves a real place to go. This journal isn't about excusing them or condemning them. It's about finally naming what you needed and didn't get — so you can stop carrying it silently.





What did you need from a parent that you didn't get?





What's a specific moment you needed them and they weren't there — for you, or in the way you needed?





What did you learn to do for yourself that a parent should have done for you?





What did other kids seem to have with their parents that you quietly wanted?





What's a story you tell yourself about why they weren't there? Is it true, or just the version that hurt least?





What did you have to grow up faster to handle?





What belief about yourself do you think came from their absence?





How does this show up in your relationships now — who you trust, who you keep close, who you push away?





What do you do differently as a parent, partner, or friend because of what you didn't get?





What's something you still find yourself seeking from other people that really belongs to this loss?





What did you have to become to survive not having what you needed?





What's a specific milestone or moment you wish they'd been there for?





What's something ordinary — a Tuesday, a school pickup, a bad day — you wish had looked different?





If you could have had one honest conversation with them, what would you want to say, and what would you want to hear back?





What does the version of them you needed look like? Write about that parent — the one who should have existed.





Write them a letter. Say the things you were never allowed to say, or never had the chance to.





What would you want them to understand about the cost of their absence?





What are you no longer waiting for them to give you?





What's a piece of the parent you needed that you're learning to give yourself now?





What's one thing that felt okay today, even a small thing?





What do you need permission to feel today — including anger, or grief for something that never existed?





Who has stepped in, even a little, to give you some of what you missed?
Name them here.





Write down one thing you know for sure about your own worth, separate from what they did or didn't give you.





*You didn't get the parent you needed.
You get to become the safety you were
looking for.*

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